

The Last Contract of White Wolf

The wind howled through the skeletal trees of Blackwood Forest, carrying with it the faint stench of rot and something far worse. Geralt of Rivia stood motionless at the edge of the clearing, his medallion vibrating softly against his chest. A monster was near. Not just any monster—this one was old, cunning, and very much aware of him.

Villagers from the nearby hamlet had spoken in hushed tones of disappearing cattle, torn bodies, and shadows that moved when no light touched them. Geralt had heard such tales countless times before. Most were exaggerations. This one was not.

He knelt beside a half-buried corpse, its form twisted unnaturally, as if something had crushed it from within. The wounds were wrong. No claws, no teeth marks. Something else. Something ancient.

“A wraith?” he muttered.

The medallion pulsed harder now.

Geralt rose slowly, hand drifting to the hilt of his silver sword. The forest fell silent. Even the wind dared not speak. That was when he saw it—a flicker between the trees. A shape without form. A presence without body.

The creature did not attack.

Instead, it circled him.

Geralt narrowed his eyes. Intelligent.

“Come out,” he called, voice steady. “I don’t get paid to chase ghosts.”

The shadows shifted.

Then it appeared.

Not fully—never fully—but enough. A distortion in the air, like heat above a flame, except colder. Much colder. The ground beneath it froze, frost creeping outward like veins.

Geralt exhaled slowly. Not a wraith.

“A specter tied to this land,” he said. “Bound. Angry.”

The creature responded with a sound that was not a sound—a pressure inside his skull, like whispers spoken directly into his thoughts. Images flashed. Blood. Fire. Betrayal.

‘Ah,’ Geralt sighed. ‘So that’s it.’

He had seen this before.

A curse.

The kind that didn’t end with silver.

The specter lunged.

Geralt reacted instantly, rolling aside as the air itself seemed to tear where he had stood. He came up with his sword drawn, blade gleaming faintly in the dim light.

“Yrden,” he whispered.

A glowing sigil formed beneath his feet, spreading outward in a violet circle. The specter hesitated as it entered the sign’s boundary, its form becoming more defined—more vulnerable.

Geralt struck.

The blade passed through it, but not cleanly. The creature shrieked, the sound echoing in places where sound should not exist. It recoiled, furious.

But it did not flee.

‘Of course not,’ Geralt muttered. ‘Never that easy.’

The specter surged again, faster this time. Geralt raised his hand.

“Quen.”

A golden shield burst into existence just as the creature collided with him. The force drove him back, boots carving into the dirt, but the shield held.

Barely.

Geralt gritted his teeth.

This wasn’t a fight he could win by steel alone.

He needed to end the curse.

The visions returned—stronger now. A burning village. A man screaming. A betrayal soaked in blood.

Geralt understood.

“You were wronged,” he said quietly.

The specter paused.

Just for a moment.

“And now you kill anything that walks these woods. That’s not justice.”

Silence.

Then rage.

It attacked again.

Geralt moved, faster than before, weaving through its strikes, his mind racing. Somewhere in this forest lay the anchor—the source of the curse.

And until he found it, this thing would not die.

He sheathed his sword.

The specter hesitated.

“Enough,” Geralt said.

He closed his eyes, focusing—not on the monster, but on the memory it carried.

The village.

The fire.

The betrayal.

And then—he saw it.

A grave.

Unmarked.

Forgotten.

Geralt opened his eyes.

“I’ll end this,” he said.

The specter screamed.

And for the first time since the fight began—

It sounded almost human.

The wind returned, and with it, the promise that not all monsters are born—some are made.